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Case Studies of NDA NOLs

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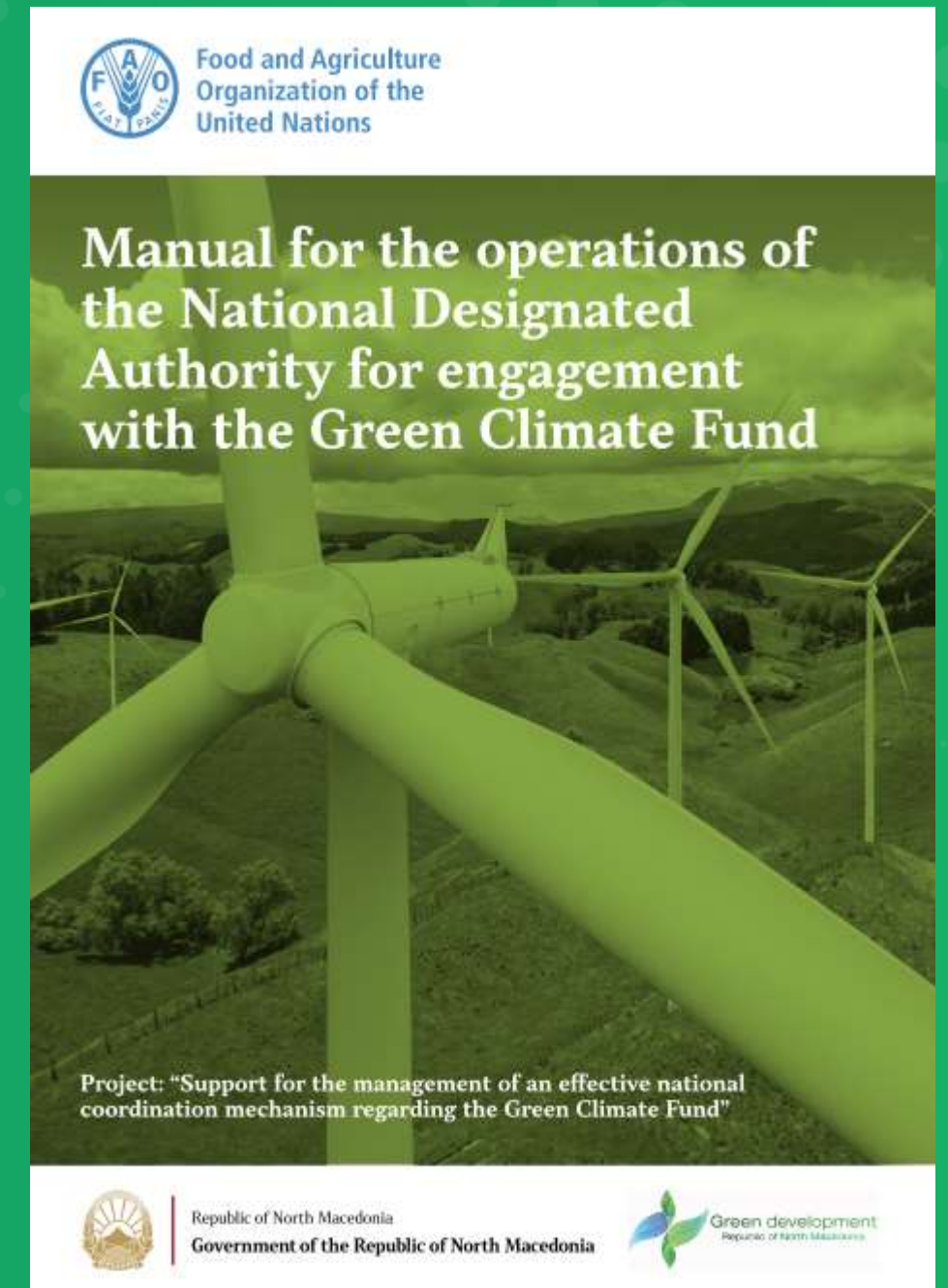
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Case studies of NDA operations- North Macedonia

North Macedonia, developed a “Manual for the operations of the NDA for engagement with the Green Climate Fund”

The Manual:

- Provides information and building understanding of GCF and national frameworks and processes,
- Accelerates North Macedonia’s engagement with GCF and facilitates investment in mitigation and adaptation activities
- Introduces key facts about access windows to GCF, the fund’s processes, investment areas and requirements
- Explains the NDA roles, the purpose of the national coordination mechanism and the responsibilities of its members
- Provides a step-by-step guidance on the No-objection procedure and country programming.



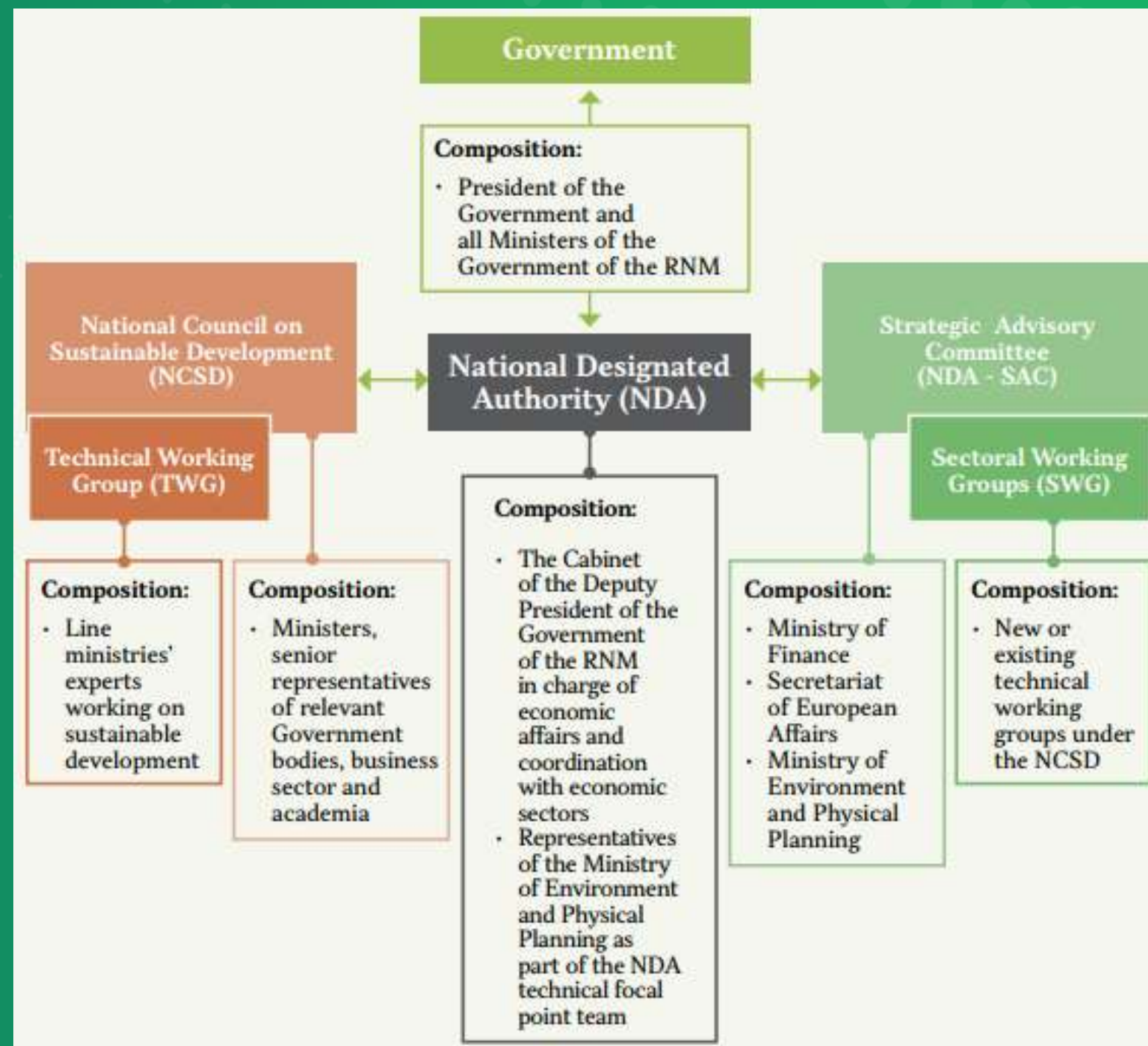


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Case studies of NDA operations- North Macedonia Cont.

The country coordination mechanism in North Macedonia consists of:

- National Designated Authority;
- Strategic Advisory Committee;
- Sectoral Working Groups;
- National Council for Sustainable Development;
- Government.





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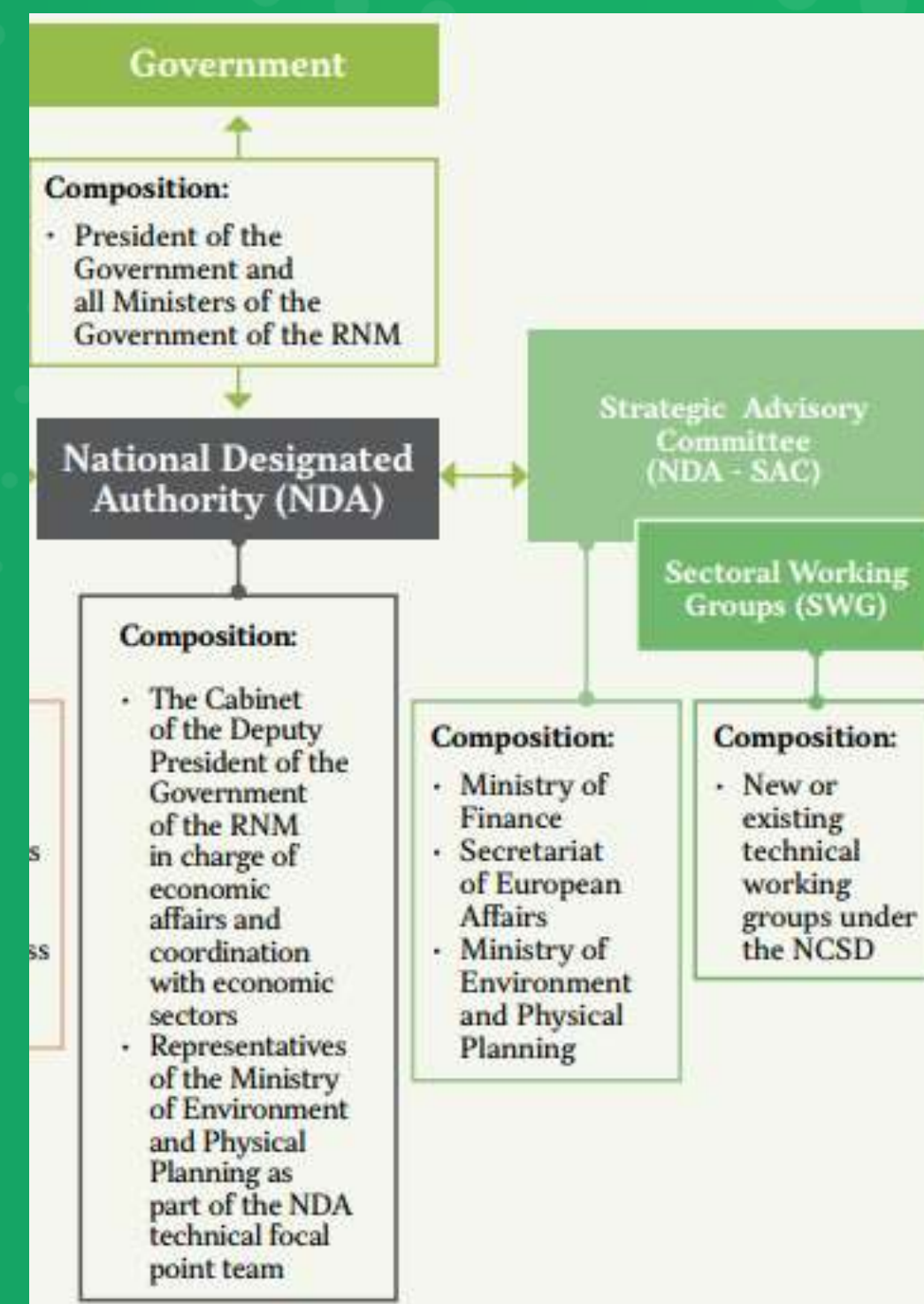
Case studies of NDA operations- North Macedonia Cont.

The Strategic Advisory Committee (NDA-SAC) is composed of representatives from the most relevant institutions regarding the GCF. Along with four members of the NDA staff, six representatives of the following institutions participate in the NDA-SAC:

- **Ministry of Finance** – 2 representatives:
 - State Secretary
 - State Counsellor from the Budgeting Sector
- **Secretariat of European Affairs (SEA)** – 2 representatives:
 - Sector for EU Funds Coordination
 - Sector for Integration
- **Ministry of Environment and Physical Planning** – 2 representatives:
 - State Secretary of the Ministry of Environment and Physical Planning
 - State Counsellor on Climate Change

The main **SWG** responsibilities are:

- To contribute to the technical discussions and project assessments, at the request of the NDA-SAC, by providing relevant information (on an ad-hock basis);
- To advise NDA-SAC on technical and operational issues in specific sectors (transport, energy, water management, waste management, agriculture, forestry, nature & biodiversity, etc.)



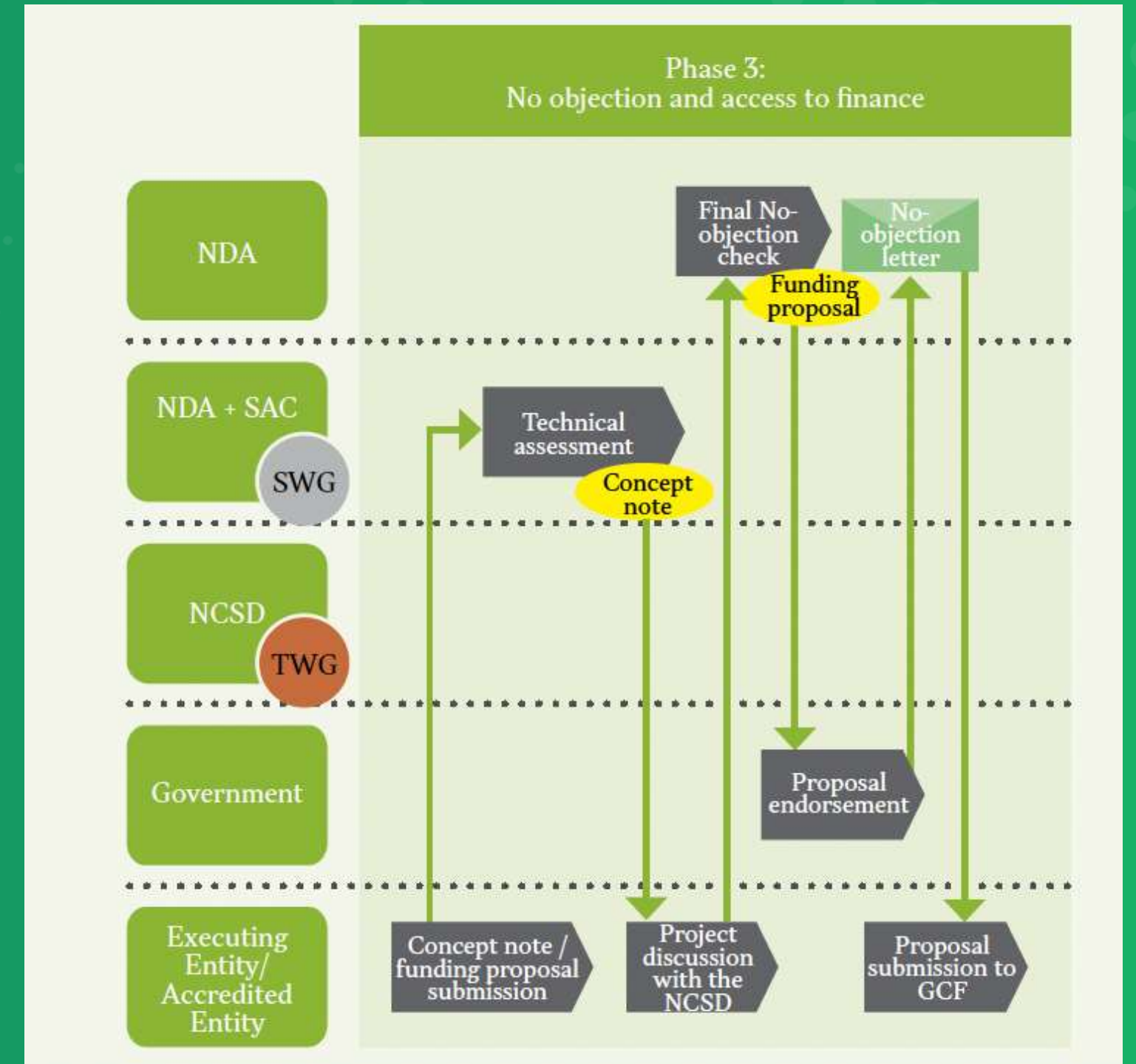


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Case studies of NDA operations- North Macedonia Cont.

NOL Submission and Review Process

1. **Proposal Submission:** Accredited Entities (AEs), or their partners, submit concept notes or funding proposals to the NDA for consideration.
2. **Initial Screening:** NDA verifies completeness of documents and checks alignment with national priorities and climate strategies (NAP, NDC, sectoral policies).
3. **Technical Review and Consultation:** Proposal is shared with relevant **line ministries, technical institutions, and stakeholders** for feedback. The review considers the GCF investment criteria, environmental and social safeguards, gender, and national development policies.
4. **NDA Evaluation:** NDA consolidates technical and stakeholder inputs, assesses overall quality, and ensures alignment with national priorities.
5. **Decision:**
 - If compliant, the NDA issues a **No Objection Letter** for submission to the GCF.
 - If concerns exist, the NDA may request revisions or decline to issue the NOL, with written justification provided to the proponent.
6. **Communication:** Approved NOLs are communicated to the GCF Secretariat and published for transparency.





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Case studies of NOL operations- Fiji

Dissemination of the NOL

The CCICD as the Fiji NDA Secretariat has developed Fiji's own national procedure which follows the GCF guidance. The NDA secretariat (CCICD) will share the procedure with the AEs and disseminate Fiji's through three main channels:

1. The **Fiji Climate Change and NDA Portal** (<https://fijiclimatchangeportal.gov.fj/>) where the GCF projects received will be listed and status reflected through regular updates to the listing;
2. The **four Climate Finance Sector Working Groups** I. Sustainable Livelihoods and Healthy Communities, II. Ecosystems and Ecosystem Services and Sustainable Land Management, III. Climate Resilient Infrastructure, Sustainable Energy, and Build Environment and IV. Sustainable transport (<https://fijiclimatchangeportal.gov.fj/nda/who-we-are/#wwa-nda-swg>)
3. **Periodic communications to stakeholders** at events and workshops and other communication channels.

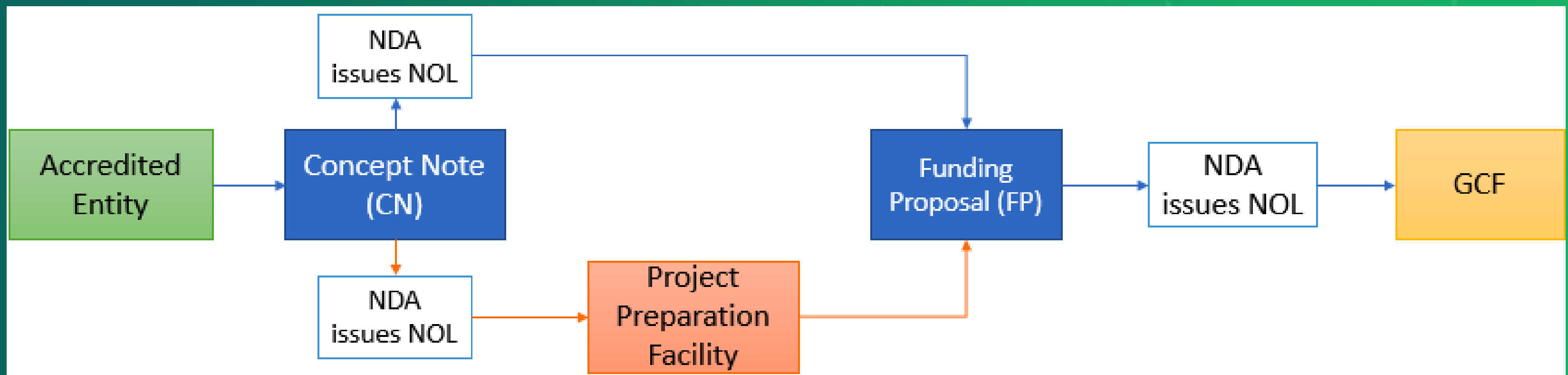


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Case studies of NOL operations- Fiji

The Fiji no-objection procedure is divided into two steps:

1. Concept Note (CN) step – A Letter of Support (LOS) is issued for CNs to be submitted to GCF. This ensures that AEs have informed the NDA secretariat of their intention to submit a CN to the GCF and provides a first screening.
2. If applying for PPF the process is to submit the CN to the NDA first to receive the PPF NOL. Once GCF approves, the PPF is provided and the FP is developed.
3. Funding Proposal (FP) step – A No Objection Letter (NOL) is issued for FPs to be submitted to the GCF. This is a more in-depth assessment of the proposed project, to ensure alignment, safeguards, consultations, and other national level requirements, including legal and regulatory requirements have been met.



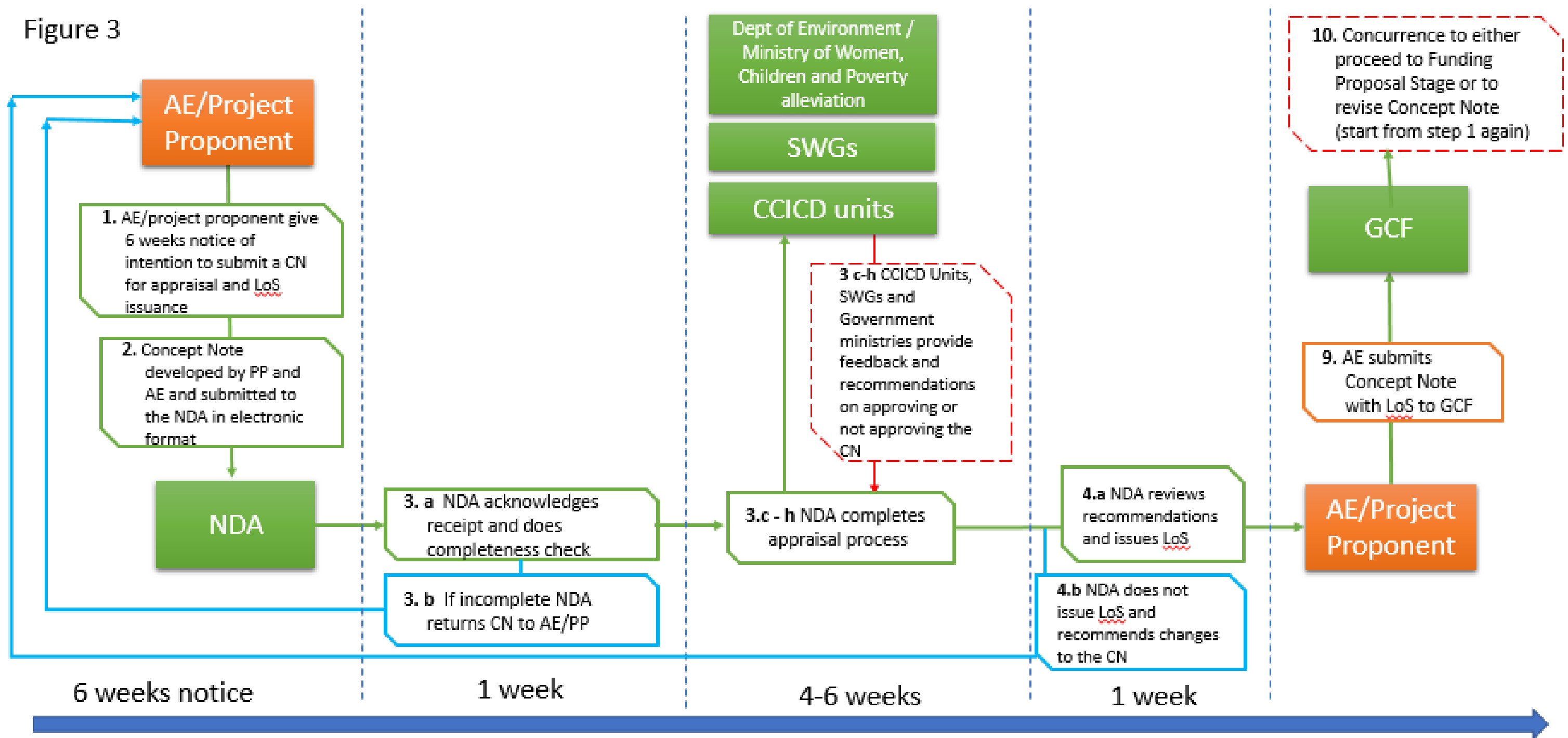


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LETTER OF SUPPORT STEP – CONCEPT NOTE STAGE (MIN 6 WEEKS – MAX 8 WEEKS)

Figure 3





Case studies of NOL Papua New Guinea

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Submission Process:

Proposal proponents should check their proposals for completeness with a project summary brief, then submit to the NDA by email. The NDA will provide an email acknowledgement of receipt.

1. Proponent submits proposal with a **project summary brief** to the NDA.
2. NDA acknowledges receipt.

ANNEX 5: Project Summary Brief Template

Contact Details			
Date			
Name			
Designation			
Organization			
Email			
Phone			
Project/Programme Summary			
Project Title			
Brief Description of Project/Programme <i>(Please limit description to 100 words)</i>			
Project/Programme Location	District: _____	Province: _____	Region: _____
Financial Arrangements			
Type of Funding Request <i>(Indicate the type of financial instrument for the funding request from GCF)</i>	☐ Grant ☐ Reimbursable Grant ☐ Guarantees ☐ Equity ☐ Subordinated Loan ☐ Senior Loan ☐ Other: Specify _____	Indicative GCF funding requested: Amount (USD): _____	
Co-financing	Amount (USD): _____	Amount (USD): _____	
Other financing	Amount (USD): _____	Amount (USD): _____	
Indicative total project/programme cost (GCF + co-finance)	Amount (USD): _____		

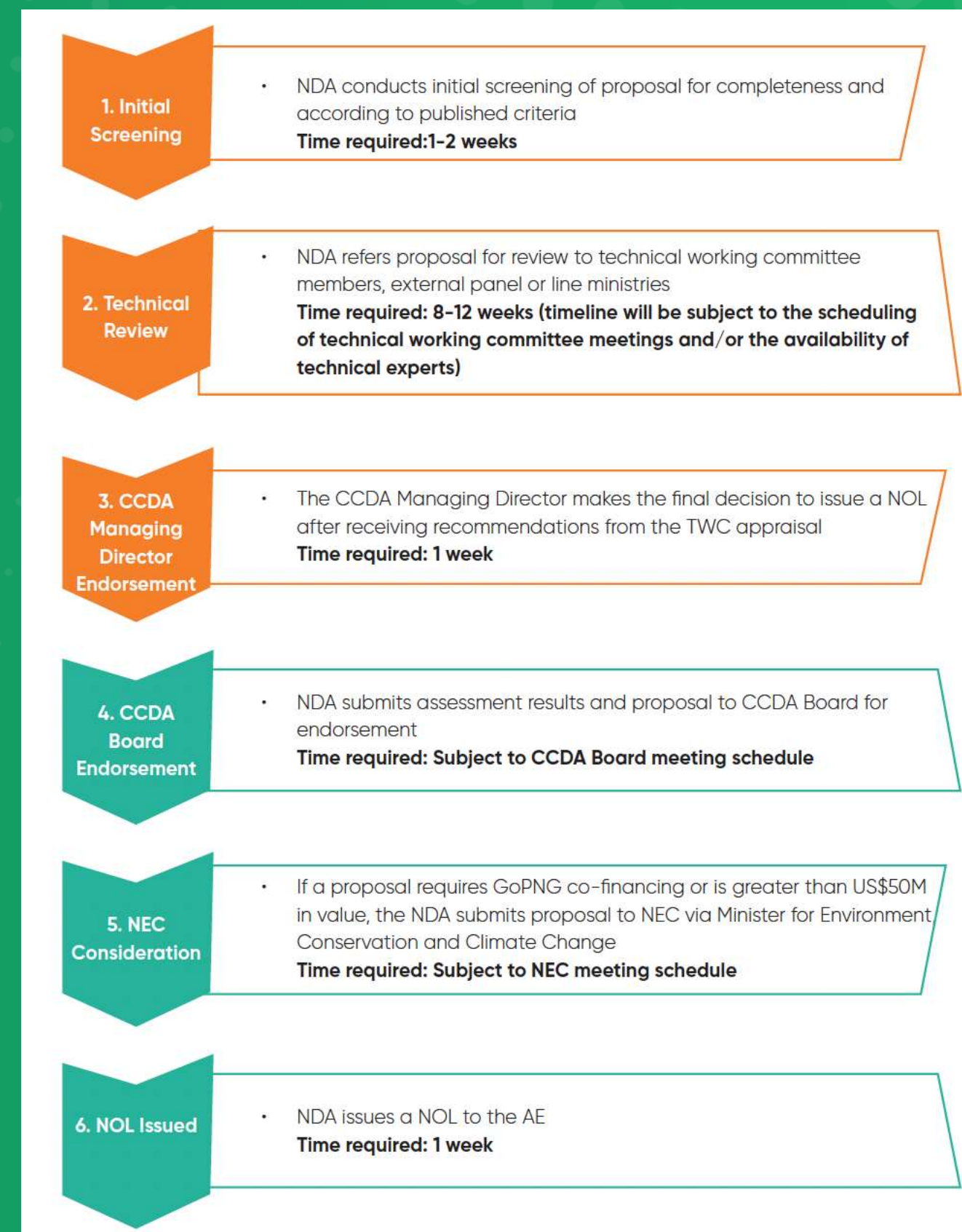


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Case studies of NOL Papua New Guinea

Steps in NDA Proposal Assessment (6-Step Approach)

- 1. Initial Screening** (1–2 weeks): NDA checks completeness and alignment.
- 2. Technical Review** (8–12 weeks): Proposal sent to Technical Working Committees, external experts, or line ministries.
- 3. Managing Director Endorsement** (1 week): NDA's Managing Director makes recommendation.
- 4. Board Endorsement:** Proposal submitted to CCDA Board.
- 5. NEC Consideration** (if proposal > USD 50M or requires GoPNG co-financing): Submission via Minister for Environment, Conservation and Climate Change.
- 6. NOL Issued** (1 week): NDA issues No Objection Letter to the AE.





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Case studies of NOL Papua New Guinea

Multi-Criteria Analysis Tool:

The NDA will apply a methodological tool called a Multi-criteria Analysis (MCA) to select proposals that are aligned with national priorities and the GCF investment criteria.

The MCA has two components:

- scoring proposals, and
- ranking and prioritizing proposals.

This MCA tool was developed specifically for application within Papua New Guinea’s development and climate change context as part of the national Country Programme. These priorities and project ideas were generated using an inclusive approach that allowed key stakeholder groups to actively engage with the NDA.

ANNEX 3: Multi-Criteria Analysis Methodology Tool and Proposal Screening Criteria				
For each criterion listed within the table below, proposed concept ideas receive 1 (low) to 3 (high) points. A weighting of 0.1 to 1.0 is allocated for each criteria (0.1 being less important and 1.0 being highly important).				
GCF Investment Criteria	Sub-criteria #	Sub-criteria	Description of sub-criteria and scoring	Weighting
1. Impact potential	1.1	Size of beneficiary group(s) and mitigation potential (GHG saving/avoidance)	i) Is this a purely development (ODA) or climate-related project/programme? ii) Adaptation measures > Size of beneficiary group(s) e.g. number of vulnerable famers impacted in the project/programme disaggregated by gender and iii) Mitigation measures > mitigation potential (GHG saving/avoidance) e.g. tCO2e/year High impact potential (5) Medium impact potential (3) Low impact potential (1)	1.0
	2.1	Sustainability (Policy, institutional, technical, financial, business, social)	High sustainability (5) – Sustainable beyond the life of the project funding (> 15 years), innovative and with strong exit strategy Medium sustainability (3) – Sustainable only over a short term (5 years) Low sustainability (1) – Not sustainable when the project funding stops with no exit strategy. Need more external funding to carry on.	1.0
2. Paradigm shift	2.2	Institutional absorptive capacity	Degree of institutional capacity and competence High capacity (5) – Public, private and CSO institutional capacity to carry on with the implementation of the outputs after the project has ended Medium capacity (3) – medium level of institutional absorptive capacity Low capacity (1) – No capacity to support the outputs when the project stops	1.0
	2.3	Scalability and replicability	High scalability/replicability (5) – Strong viable business case, value chain actors empowered and incentivized to scale up within the project sites and able to replicate the outputs to other provinces even after the project has ended Medium scalability/replicability (3) Low scalability/replicability (1) – Limited capacity to carry on with the outputs when the project has ended – ‘white elephant’ project	0.8
	2.4	Monitoring and Evaluation	Presence or absence of monitoring and evaluation (M&E) plan: High presence of M&E plan (5) – Strong opportunity to develop a robust M&E plan with SMART indicators (baseline vs. target) Medium presence of M&E plan (3) Low presence of M&E plan (1) – Limited opportunity to develop a robust M and E plan	0.8

Differences between the Processes

	Papua New Guinea (PNG)	Fiji	North Macedonia
Who Can Submit	Only Accredited Entities (AEs); non-accredited must partner with AE.	Only AEs can submit; non-accredited may partner with AEs.	Only AEs or partners can submit; NDA validates.
Process Overview	Structured 6-step process: initial screening, technical review, endorsement by Managing Director, Board, Cabinet (if > USD 50M), NDA issues NOL.	Submission → screening → review & consultations with ministries/stakeholders → technical assessment → NDA decision → communication to GCF.	Submission → initial screening → technical review & consultations → NDA evaluation → decision → communication & publication.
Stakeholder Involvement	Technical Working Committees, line ministries, external experts.	Line ministries, technical experts, stakeholder consultations.	Line ministries, technical institutions, and broader stakeholders engaged.
Decision Authority	NDA Managing Director, CCDA Board, and Cabinet for large-scale proposals.	NDA makes final decision; Cabinet-level clearance for proposals with significant implications.	NDA consolidates inputs, issues NOL; supported by coordination mechanism.
Timeframe	Up to 12–16 weeks for review (longer for >USD 50M requiring Cabinet).	4–6 weeks for concept notes; longer for full proposals depending on complexity.	30–60 days depending on scope and consultations.
Transparency	All NOLs published on GCF website and nationally.	NDA encouraged to publish decisions nationally.	NOL decisions documented and published; NDA has operations manual for clarity.
Unique Features	Strong use of Multi-Criteria Analysis (MCA) and Cabinet endorsement for large projects.	Flexible timelines, emphasis on early engagement with NDA to avoid delays.	NDA uses a Country Coordination Mechanism and Operations Manual to institutionalize the process.